

Class 8: Aspects of Social Movement Activity

Social movement coalitions

Dr. Michael C. Zeller

Agenda for the day

- Opening notes
- Poll: SM coalitions opening questions
- Movement coalitions
- Coalitions between parties and movements
- Any questions, concerns, feedback for this class?

Opening notes



Presentation groups

December

January

Presentations line-up

Date	Presenters	Method
4 Dec:		TBD
11 Dec:		TBD
18 Dec:		TBD

Poll: SM coalitions opening questions



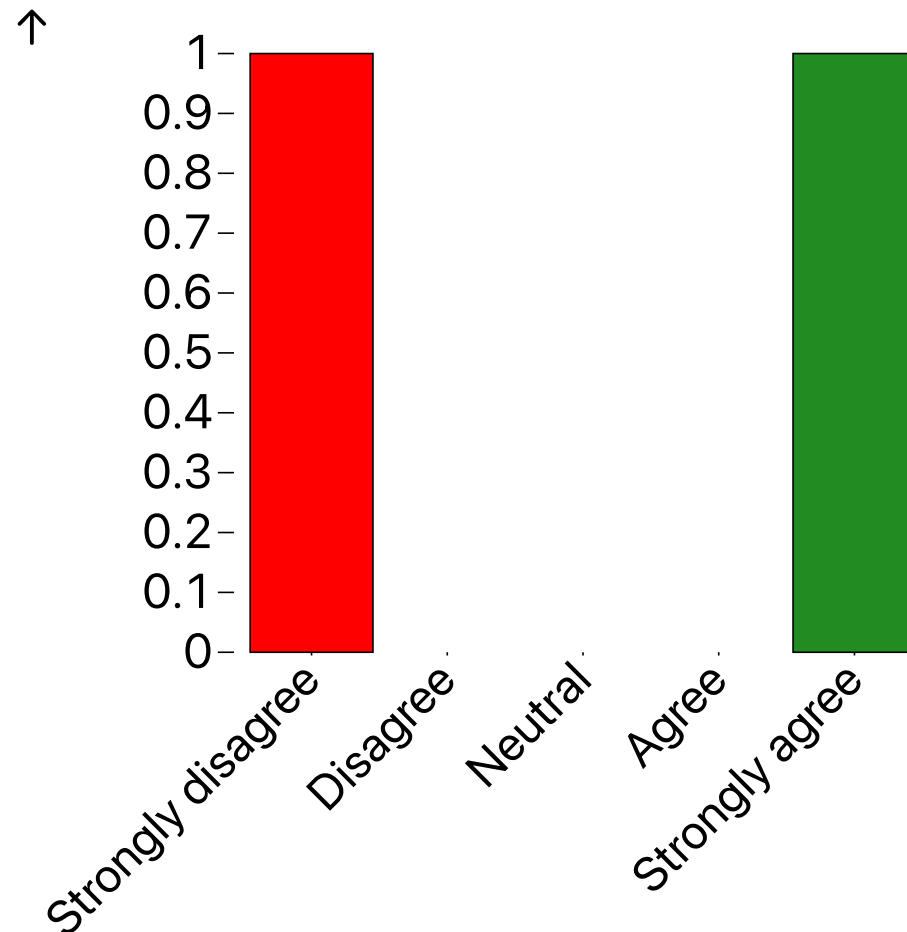
Take the survey at

<https://forms.gle/qmXcNdhWNN3eNNPC8>

- are coalitions helpful to achieve goals?
- short-term, limited coalitions more likely to achieve goals?
- factor most important in facilitating coalition formation?
- most important benefit for a movement in forming a coalition?
- identity-based movements struggle more to form coalitions?

Poll results (Respondents: 2)

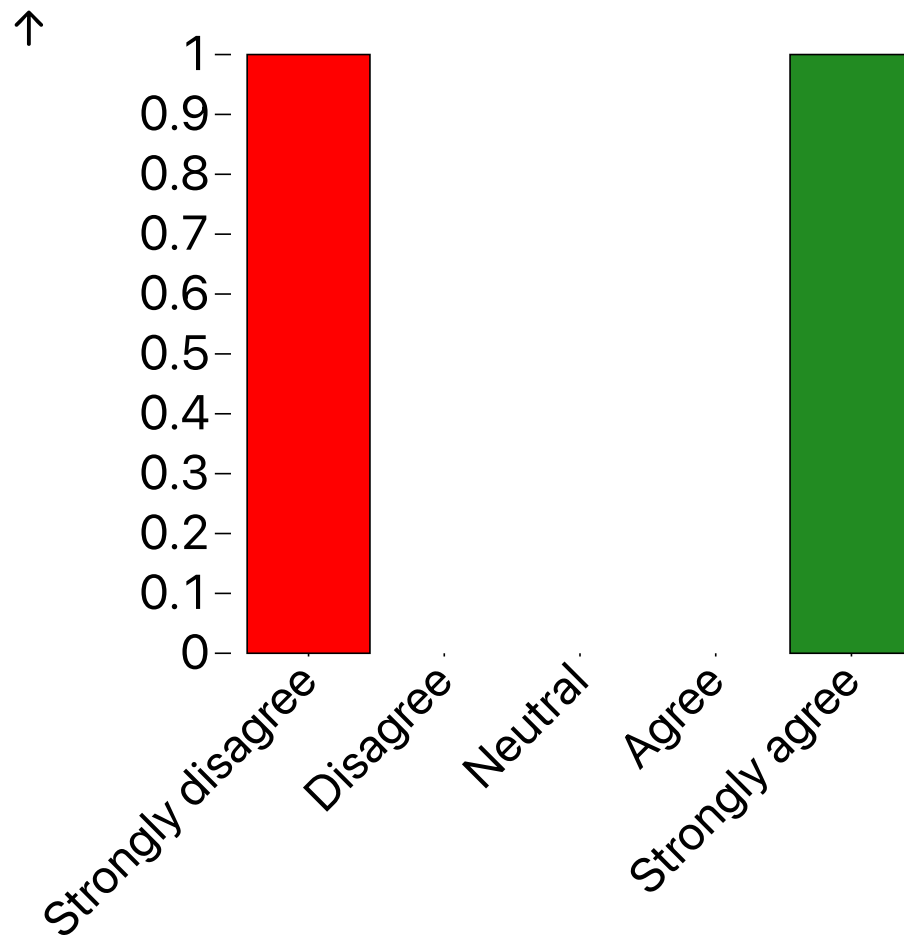
Are coalitions helpful to achieve goals?



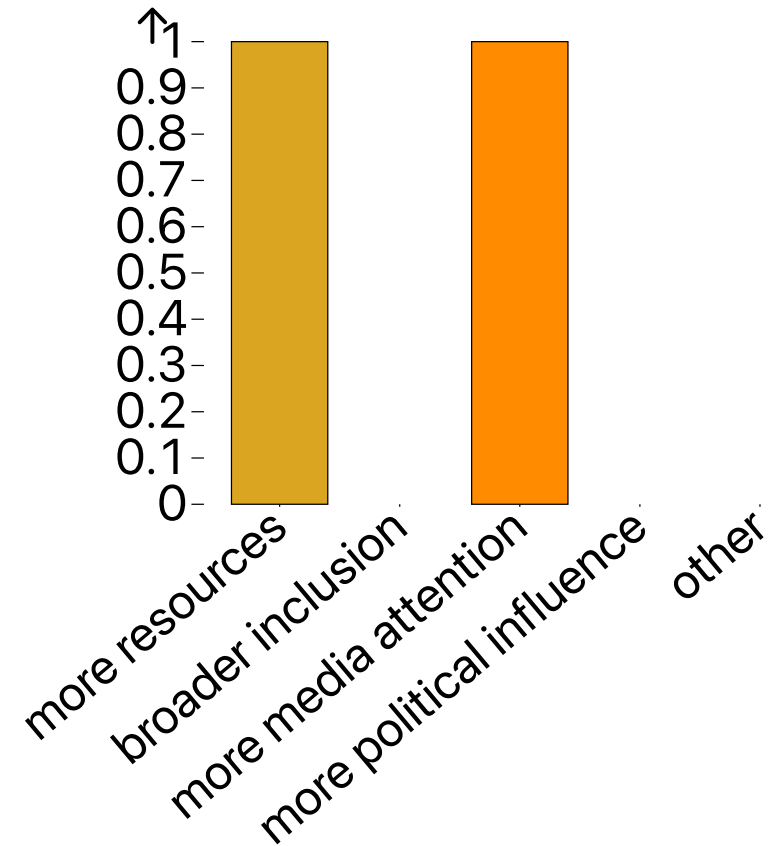
What are the advantages and disadvantages for movements of forming a coalition/collaborating with other actors?

Poll results - why coalition

short-term, limited coalitions
more likely to achieve goals?



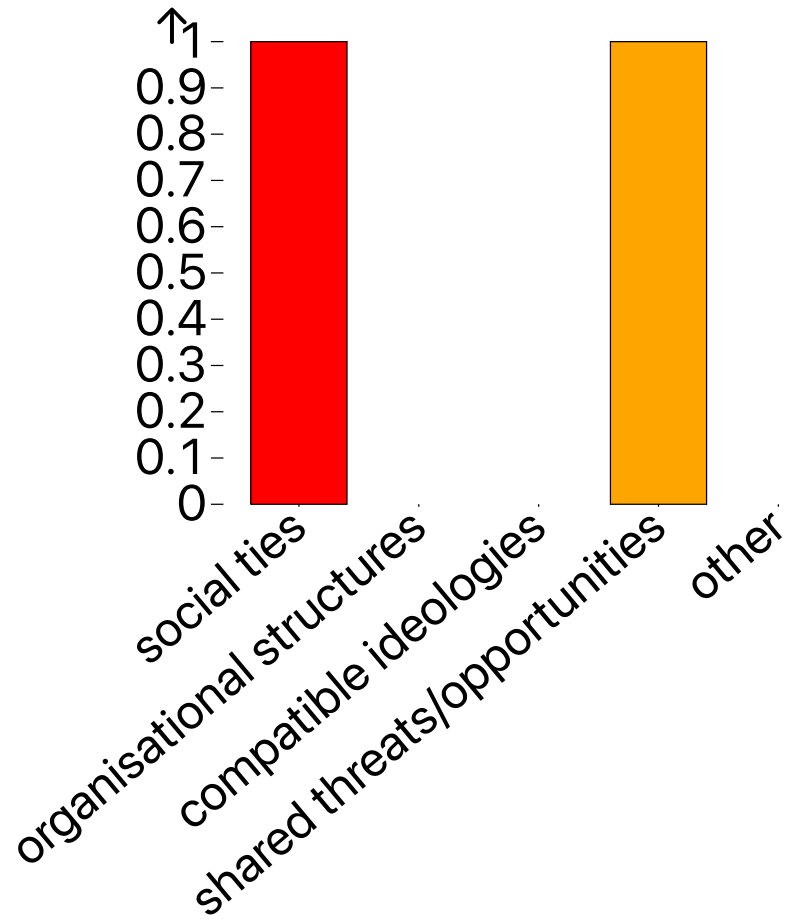
most important benefit for a
movement in forming a coalition?



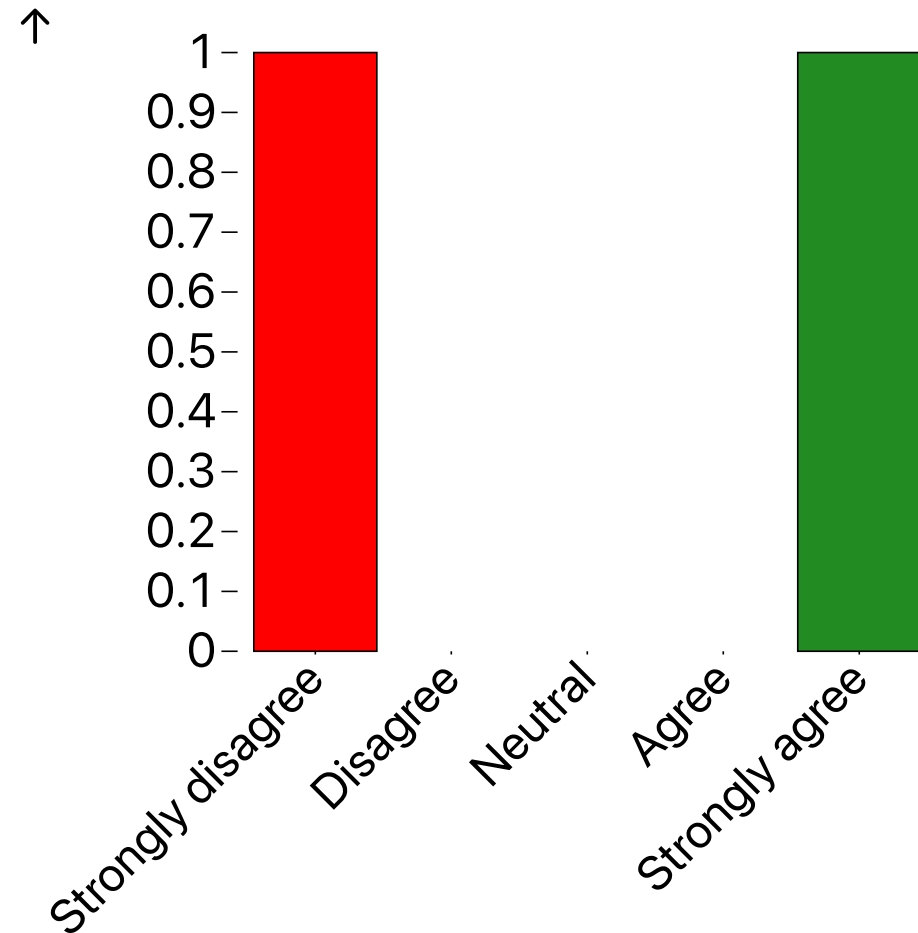
What factors enable/hinder coalition formation?

Poll results - coalition how

factor most important in
facilitating coalition formation?



identity-based movements
struggle more to form coalitions?



Movement coalitions

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MÜNCHEN

Why movements make coalitions

Coalitions...

- help build/enhance **networks**
- increase **resource** availability
 - boost **mobilisation** potential (again, networks)
- expand **tactical repertoires**

Types of coalitions

Some coalitions may be enduring; others may be event coalitions



Types of coalitions

Some coalitions may be **enduring**; others may be **event coalitions**

Peace protest, Berlin, 2022-02-27



Van Dyke and Amos (2017) identify five factors critical to coalition formation:

1. **social ties** - connections between organisations
2. **conducive organizational structures** - structures that enable collaboration
3. **ideology, culture, and identity** - shared ideas
4. **institutional environment** - opportunities and threats
5. **resources** - pooling resources or competing

Coalition formation - intra-/inter-organisational factors



Coalition formation - intra-/inter-organisational factors



- commonalities and connections between organisations
 - ‘plentiful resources and congruent ideologies’ (2015)
 - overlapping collective identities (e.g., Memorial and Sakharov Centre)
- ideological compatibility (a necessary condition?)
 - splits within movement (e.g., TERF vs. inclusive feminist groups) by ‘minor’ differences
 - others accommodate ...

Coalition formation - intra-/inter-organisational factors



- related to **opportunity structures**
 - **opportunities** - *general or specific openings for mobilisation or movement activism*
 - e.g., northern Ireland civil rights groups found international partners in late 1960s partly due to generally high social mobilisation — access to others'/more/shared resources
 - **threats:**
 - e.g., government repression often drives organisations to collaborate (e.g., For Fair Elections movement in Russia)

Coalition formed amid government repression

For Fair Elections (Russia, 2011-2012) - strange bedfellows



- related to **opportunity structures**
 - *institutional arrangements*:
 - Obach (2010) suggests that U.S. governmental separation of labor and environmental protection into two separate policy arenas inhibits collaboration of labor and environmental groups even when issues are of interest to both.
- **Free space** facilitates the organization of coalitions:

settings within a community or movement that are removed from the direct control of dominant groups, are voluntarily participated in, and generate the cultural challenge that precedes or accompanies political mobilization” (Polletta, 1999: 1).

Coalition formation - summary and 'potential'

Grouping	Factors	
Intra-org	exclusive vs. multiple affiliations	any bridging social ties?
	broad organisational goals	e.g., bridging frames
	strong organisation	division (and availability) of labour, professional leaders, (at least some) hierarchy
Inter-org	commonalities	available resources, overlapping collective identities
	ideological compatibility	factions vs. willingness to accommodate
Opportunity structure	opportunities	free space
	threats	
	institutional arrangements	

What's the **coalition potential** of movement cases you know of? Have they formed *enduring* and/or *event* coalitions?

Risks of coalition formation

- where there is *disparity/imbalance*...
 - **resource-rich** organisations may try to control **resource-poor** partner organisations

Coalitions and movement outcomes (2015)

radical flank effects - dynamics between (relatively) moderate and (relatively) radical parts of a movement and their target(s)

Radical flanks and (non/violent) tactics (Chenoweth Stephan 2011)

Pay attention to the mechanisms that Prof. Chenoweth specifies in her brief explanation

Radical flanks and (non/violent) tactics (Chenoweth Stephan 2011)

Pay attention to the mechanisms that Prof. Chenoweth specifies in her brief explanation

- nonviolent campaigns are better at eliciting broad and diverse support
- nonviolent campaigns create more defections among the opposition
- nonviolent campaigns have a broader set of tactics at their disposal
- nonviolent campaigns often maintain discipline even in the face of escalating oppression

Coalitions and movement outcomes (2015)

	Unified movement	Within-movement conflict	Radical flank effect
Open <i>political opportunity structure</i>	<i>Political success:</i> able to win political reforms from receptive elites	<i>Lack of political success:</i> may undermine movement mobilisation and prevent activists from achieving their political goals	<i>Political success:</i> Receptive elites willing to side with moderates against radicals ('positive radical flank effect'), making moderate reforms
		Within-movement conflict and radical flank effect	
Closed <i>political opportunity structure</i>	<i>Lack of political success:</i> unlikely to win political gains due to lack of political elite receptiveness	<i>Political success:</i> initially unreceptive elites persuaded to side with moderates against radicals ('positive radical flank effect')	

Coalitions between parties and movements

- A. S. Heinze and Weisskircher (2022)
 - research questions
 - types of party responses
 - findings
- further questions



How have German political parties responded to anti-Corona street protests?

What do you recall from the height of the pandemic? How did parties (in Germany and elsewhere) respond to mobilisation?

Types of party responses

A. Heinze (2018) on **party reactions** to radical **parties** (somewhat compelled to react):

Disengage

1. ignore
2. legal restrictions
3. cordon sanitaire (blocking coalitions)
4. demonise
5. defuse
6. hold

Engage

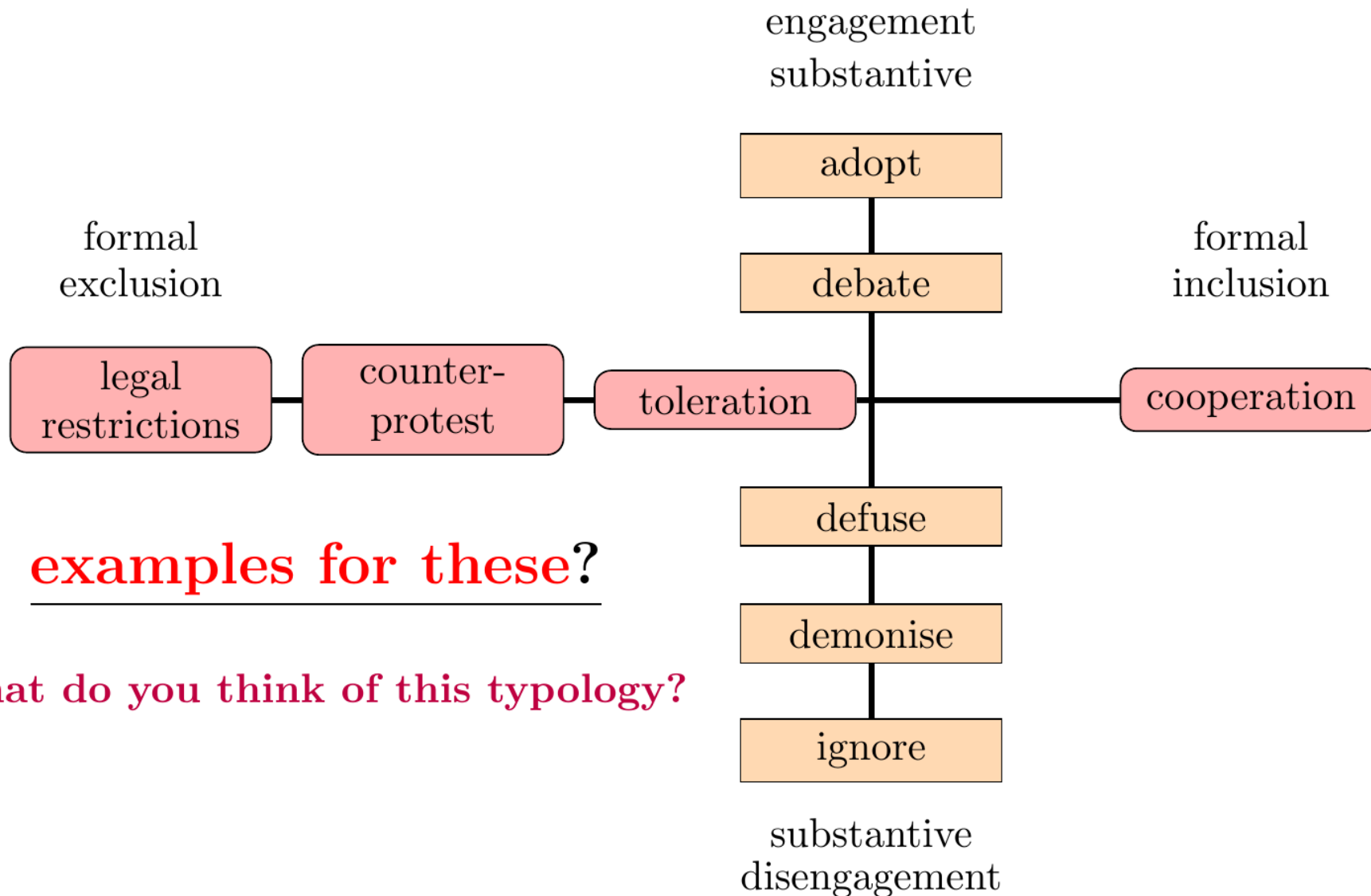
7. adopt (co-opt) policies
8. collaborate (executive, legislative, electoral) [national, regional, local – e.g., cooperation with AfD at lower levels]

Types of party responses

A. S. Heinze and Weisskircher (2022) on **party responses** to **movements** (not necessarily compelled to react):

- **dismissive**: ignore or disregard the movement
- **accommodative**: legitimate or even collaborate with the movement
- **adversarial**: oppose/challenge the movement

Heinze and Weisskricher (2022) - response options



Heinze and Weisskricher (2022) - response options

Level	Action	Description
Formal level	legal restrictions	most exclusionary possibility: e.g., bans, forced dissolution, event restrictions
	counterprotest	parties can mobilise counterdemonstrations against pariah protest
	tolerate	neutral acceptance of the right to protest, even for those that are regarded as pariahs; passive option
	cooperate	act cooperatively with protest group; mobilise support base
Substantive level	ignore	disregard, refuse to comment on protest
	demonise	portray the actor as extreme, dangerous, irrational, or beyond the pale
	defuse	downplay protest issue importance, shift public attention to other issue(s)
	debate	acknowledges the importance of an issue put forward by the protestors, with parties discussing different policy positions
	adopt	adopting positions from protest arena becomes attractive if party considers the issue particularly relevant for competition, hoping to gain electoral advantage

Heinze and Weisskricher (2022) - findings

Formal level - response to *Querdenken*

Party	Legal Restrictions	Counterprotest	Tolerate	Cooperate
CDU	Yes	No	Yes	No
SPD	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Greens	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Left	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
FDP	Yes	No	Yes	No
AfD	No	No	Yes	Yes

Substantive level - response to *Querdenken*

Party	Ignore	Demonise	Defuse	Debate	Adopt
CDU	No	Yes	No	Yes	No
SPD	No	Yes	No	Yes	No
Greens	No	Yes	No	Yes	No
Left	No	Yes	No	Yes	No
FDP	No	Yes	No	Yes	No
AfD	No	Yes	No	Yes	Yes

what about movement
responses/approaches *to* parties?

(is it as relevant? does it matter? movements are not as *empowered* as parties)

is the epitome of social movement
'success' becoming a party?

Any questions, concerns, feedback for this class?

Anonymous feedback here: <https://forms.gle/AjHt6fcnwZxkSg4X8>

Alternatively, please send me an email: m.zeller@lmu.de

References

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